

Incident Post-Mortem - INC-2025-041 - DNS Propagation Failure

Incident Summary

Field	Value
Incident ID	INC-2025-041
Date	2025-07-14
Severity	P1 Customer-Facing Outage
Duration	195 minutes
Lead Responder	Corey Holloway
Affected	All public API endpoints; dashboard

Timeline

- 14:02 PT: PagerDuty alert synthetic monitor failures all regions.
- 14:05 PT: Corey acknowledged; initial hypothesis routing issue.
- 14:22 PT: Root cause narrowed to DNS; TTL mismatch identified.
- 15:10 PT: DNS record corrected; propagation began globally.
- 17:17 PT: All monitors green; incident closed.

Root Cause

DNS record update with TTL 86400 seconds from prior maintenance. When record needed updating resolvers held stale data for full TTL. High TTL reduced resolver load but created unacceptable failover latency.

Action Items

Action	Owner	Due	Status
Lower TTL critical DNS records to 300s	Corey Holloway	2025-07-21	Complete
Add DNS health check monitors	Chen Wei	2025-07-28	Complete
Document DNS TTL policy in runbook	Corey Holloway	2025-08-04	Complete
Quarterly DNS config audit	SRE Team	Recurring	Active

Lessons Learned

- TTL optimization and failover agility are in tension; document and review.
- Synthetic monitors should include DNS resolution checks not just HTTP status.
- P1 runbook updated: DNS as candidate root cause in first five minutes of triage.